him. Besides, he accused the holding company, its directors and certain trustees of Tata Trusts of lapses in governance.

The first letter he wrote was to Tata Steel on 12 December. In it, he levelled a litany of charges against Ratan. These ranged from the latter 'effectively destroying' the traditions established by JRD to compelling the company to share information on Tata Steel Europe in violation of SEBI Insider Trading Regulation. Some of the strongest criticism against Ratan related to the acquisition of Corus which Wadia alleged was at Lord Kumar Bhattacharyya's behest. The second letter was to the board and shareholders of Tata Motors. In it, Wadia called the Nano a 'serious drain on the financial resources' of the company and claimed that Tata Motors was, in fact, 'burdened with heavy debt'. The last letter was addressed to Tata Chemicals. In it, Wadia questioned the merger of the Haldia plant with Tata Chemicals in 2003, with which he said that he had 'differed strongly'. He also said that he had 'expressed serious apprehensions' about the company's acquisition of the UK-based Brunner Mond Group in 2005. He further alleged that 'during the last 10 years', because of the company's 'various acquisitions', the 'consolidated debt' of Tata Chemicals had gone up from Rs 1,827 crore to Rs 8,695 crore.

All these claims and counterclaims soon came up before the court of the shareholders for final adjudication.

The EGMs as the Jury

TIL held the first of the EGMs on 12 December to remove Mistry as a director on its board. He was removed from the directorship. After the EGM was over, the company issued a simple press release. The next EGM was that of TCS on 13 December. It was chaired by former HSBC Asia-Pacific CEO and independent director Aman Mehta after Interim Chairman Ishaat Hussain excused himself from the proceedings to avoid allegations of impropriety as he was a Tata Sons' nominee. The EGM was attended by Ratan and Krishna Kumar. It was the first time Ratan had attended a TCS meeting in two years. As the overwhelming majority of the shares of the company was owned by Tata Sons, Mistry was removed as director of the company with a 93.11 per cent majority vote.

The next EGM was that of TTSL, held on the following day. It was a tame affair with the shareholders voting unanimously to remove Mistry.